

DAB on Data

DAB ENERGY TRUST — Doubs • Adamstown • Buckeystown

Our Home, Our Coalition

September 18, 2026

We like it here. Keep Frederick looking like Frederick.

Compiled packet for County Executive, County Council, Planning Commission, and residents. Not a campaign committee filing.

B. Personal Statement — Nicholas Markoff

I live in the Buckeystown / DAB area of Frederick County, Maryland. I am a working neighbor, not a candidate for office.

My vote in the local election will be tied solely to attaching this Memo to the datacenter agreement

I am offering a clear path. No other candidate I have seen is offering one.

I am not running for office.

I am fighting for my community anyway.

This packet is that path: a DAB ENERGY TRUST for Doubs, Adamstown, and Buckeystown — operator-funded meter credits for the host communities that live next to the Critical Digital Infrastructure overlay, with a grandfather clause that rewards keeping the Frederick we already have, and a public declaration that the host-community rebate is due because Winchester Hall's numbers came off Manor Woods ground.

Neighbors with a plan. Not a lawsuit. Not a protest. Not a campaign committee.

All we need is emails and signatures these days, no muskets! So, are there really any excuses?

Respectfully,

Nicholas Markoff

Buckeystown / DAB area, Frederick County, MD

September 18, 2026

C. Official Plan / Memo Body

FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND

MEMORANDUM FOR PUBLIC FILING

TO: County Executive; County Council; Planning Commission

FROM: Nicholas Markoff, DAB ENERGY TRUST (Doubs · Adamstown · Buckeystown), Frederick County, MD

DATE: September 18, 2026

RE: DAB ENERGY TRUST — condition new CDI load and any DRRA on a local energy dividend, infrastructure leasehold, and residual interest for Doubs, Adamstown, and Buckeystown only

ACTION: Introduce, enact, and attach to any revived Quantum / Catellus DRRA or site plan

Formerly styled Adamstown–Buckeystown Energy Trust in prior draft filings.

Subtitle: Doubs · Adamstown · Buckeystown — Our Home, Our Coalition

1. Request

Enact a **DAB ENERGY TRUST** for residential electric meters whose service address lies within:

- (a) the **Adamstown Census Designated Place (CDP)**,
- (b) the **Buckeystown CDP** (2020 Census places), or
- (c) a **Doubs** service address on a **published Doubs parcel / service-address list** to be adopted by County Council ordinance.

Doubs is an unincorporated populated place / hamlet (GNIS Class U6), not a Census CDP. Until that Doubs list exists, public materials may describe Tier 1 as: Adamstown CDP + Buckeystown CDP (**1,209 Census households**) plus Doubs addresses on the published Doubs list.

Condition certificates of occupancy for additional Critical Digital Infrastructure (CDI) electrical load, and any Development Rights and Responsibilities Agreement, on three tools:

- **A. Energy Trust** — operators pay per energized megawatt; 100 percent of the dividend goes to eligible DAB meters until the proposed ordinance floor is met.
- **C. Infrastructure stake** — county or co-op holds title or a recorded lease on campus-serving water, sewer, roads, and right-of-way pads the public pays for; rent to the Trust.
- **D. Residual / equity** — covenant on land rezoned into LI or GI inside the overlay after January 20, 2026; seek 2027 state authority for a non-voting economic interest in CDI projects over 50 MW, dedicated to this Trust.

Do not fund the dividend by raising the real-property tax rate in these three communities. **Do not** exchange a multi-year zoning freeze for a one-time community-benefits package.

Exclusive by design. This Trust is for Doubs, Adamstown, and Buckeystown only — **not Frederick City.**

No freeloader expansion without a board vote **AND** a new County Council ordinance titled as an expansion (plus elder consult under Article IX-A). No matter who residents vote for, data centers are still going to be built here — a slogan does not stop steel. Get what is due: operator-funded meter credits (more money in household pockets) and a boundary that protects these places from freeloaders and the apartment/sprawl wave that tends to follow. Dividend = floor; boundary = wall.

Elder consult on geography changes (bylaws Article IX-A). Before the board votes on any Tier 1 geography change — adopting or majorly amending the Doubs list, expanding Tier 1 to another community, or otherwise amending the Article III geography lock — it must consult in good faith with ten residents age 65 or older who have lived in Doubs, Adamstown, or Buckeystown for at least ten years. The consult is advisory, on the record, and not a veto; a short summary goes with the minutes. It does not apply to routine clerical addressing corrections that do not enlarge Tier 1, or to automatic Census sync of Adamstown/Buckeystown CDP lines.

Board representation lock (bylaws Article IV). Five voting members; each of the three communities must hold at least one voting seat at all times. Default apportionment 2 Adamstown / 2 Buckeystown / 1 Doubs; Council may change the split by ordinance only if each town still has ≥ 1 seat. Until the Doubs list is adopted, the Doubs seat may be held interim by a Doubs-hamlet-area resident; once the list is live, that seat is Doubs-list only.

2. Why these three communities

Ordinance **26-01-001** (effective **January 20, 2026**) mapped the CDI overlay — approximately **2,614.9 acres** (Maryland Supreme Court figure) — onto the former Eastalco plant north of Adamstown. Those acres are roughly described by the industrial and grid edge around New Design Road, Manor Woods Road, Adamstown Road, Ballenger Creek Pike, and Digital Drive (geographic descriptors, not metes-and-bounds; see the Ord. 26-01-001 map exhibit). Buckeystown and Doubs (unincorporated populated place / hamlet, not a Census CDP) sit on that same rural-industrial and grid edge.

This is not for city folk up in Frederick who have been moving in and changing everything. It is for people who actually live here — Doubs, Adamstown, Buckeystown — Our Home, Our Coalition. We are neighbors with a plan, not a protest.

Lived impact in Buckeystown is not a sterile statistic. MD 85 is Buckeystown Pike — a state highway through the Buckeystown Historic District. Sidewalks broken or missing, and highway speeds through a village with an aging population, are part of daily life for residents who drive that road. Residents pull out onto that road the way you would time a gap in freeway traffic. That is morning life on the overlay's doorstep — not a PowerPoint slide.

Tier 1: residential meters in the Adamstown CDP, Buckeystown CDP, or on the published Doubs list. Hard Census total for the two CDPs: **710 + 499 = 1,209** households (about 1,210). No Doubs household count is asserted. No invented mile distances or substation proper names.

ZIP codes are not the eligibility lock. ZIP 21710 may roughly track Adamstown street delivery, but ZIP 21717 is a USPS PO Box-only ZIP (zero residential street-delivery mailboxes) and does not cover Buckeystown street addresses. Many Buckeystown street addresses use ZIP 21704, a large delivery area with thousands of households — far too broad for a three-community Trust. Before the first payment, the County Council shall publish a meter eligibility list mapped to Adamstown and Buckeystown CDP boundaries and parcels, and to the adopted Doubs list.

3. Money already collected — not a local energy credit

HR&A Advisors (October 30, 2025), Tables 3 and 14, report Quantum-related recordation tax through 2025 year-to-date as follows: **\$1.40 million** on the Eastalco purchase, **\$6.67 million** on tenant sales, and **\$44.9 million** on debt service — **\$52.97 million** in total, or about **\$53 million**. County Executive Jessica Fitzwater testified that the project had already generated “over \$50 million in recordation tax revenue as of November 2025” (SB 427 testimony, February 18, 2026). The same HR&A tables report \$2.24 million in real property tax on land through 2025 YTD. This filing does not claim a June 30, 2026 county ledger total.

Recordation is split by formula among agricultural preservation, parks, schools, housing, and the general fund; a 2 percent transit share begins in FY2027 under Bill 26-03. That money does not appear as a power-bill credit on Adamstown, Buckeystown, or Doubs meters.

On **September 1, 2026**, the County Executive announced a Catellus community-benefits package headlined as “**\$110 million**” and tied to a proposed Development Rights and Responsibilities Agreement. The published line items were \$30 million for Carroll Manor Elementary School renovations; \$40 million for a community center and recreational space; \$14.5 million for workforce development and career and technical education; \$10.5 million for agricultural land preservation; \$10 million for perimeter berming, planting, and trails; \$5 million for a community solar project to reduce energy bills for Adamstown residents; and \$1 million for a fire engine for the Carroll Manor Volunteer Fire Company — **\$111.0 million** if those figures are added as printed — together with roughly a 20 percent reduction in planned square footage, an 80 percent reduction in potable water use, and a 433-acre nature reserve on campus. This filing uses the county’s “\$110 million” headline and notes the \$111.0 million line-item sum without inventing a reconciliation. The County Executive **rejected** that package on **September 14, 2026**. New CDI applications remain paused through July 1, 2027 (executive-order extension of September 14, 2026). Vested and under-construction work continues.

The Trust is a different instrument: an ongoing, megawatt-funded meter credit for the three host communities, not a one-time DRR package. This filing does not propose exchanging a multi-year zoning freeze for that package or any successor one-time list. Candidates selling victimhood offer a feeling; this filing offers the deal in §1 — what is due, money in pockets, and a closed boundary.

4. Campus scale used for the formula

Published program for Quantum Frederick / the Catellus lead-developer campus: planned **2.4 gigawatts**, about **17.4 million square feet**, on about **2,100 acres**. That campus figure is not the same number as the CDI overlay acreage (~**2,614.9 acres**). Prefer “planned 2.4 GW” as the primary program figure.

The campus was not at stabilized operations as of mid-2026; construction is underway. Aligned Data Centers: about **264 MW** planned across the campus; building IAD-04 (about **72 MW**) topped out in January 2026. Rowan Digital / AWS Bauxite construction is underway.

Countywide annual forecasts at full buildout / stabilization (not meter credits in Doubs, Adamstown, or Buckeystown — **not DAB pocket money**):

- Sage Policy Group (October 2023): about **\$40.9 million** (about **\$41 million**) annual county fiscal revenue — about \$37.7 million real property plus about \$3.2 million income tax.

- County Executive SB 427 testimony (February 18, 2026): “approximately **\$68.8 million** annually in real property taxes” for the already-approved project.
- HR&A Table 16 (October 30, 2025): about **\$215 million** annual fiscal revenue (\$195 million real property on improvements + \$13.2 million real property on land + \$4.74 million personal income tax + \$2.04 million stormwater fee; table total \$214.98 million).

Those are Winchester Hall numbers, not Manor Woods numbers.

5. Proposed dividend (policy illustration — not enacted law)

The **\$250 floor** and **\$1,000 cap** below are a **proposed** ordinance floor and cap for Council to enact. They are **not current law**.

Rule	About 1,209 CDP homes (Adamstown + Buckeystown); Doubs meters TBD on published list	Notes
Proposed floor \$250 / meter / year after first hall energized	≈ \$302,250 ≈ \$302,000 / year to the two CDPs alone (Doubs add-on when list exists)	Proposed ordinance floor (annual)
\$1 per MWh of campus IT load, eligible DAB meters only	72 MW hall @ 70% load ≈ \$441,000 (≈ \$365 / meter if only the 1,209 CDP meters)	Illustration, not a tariff — annual credit tracks prior-12-month campus IT load between floor and cap
Proposed cap \$1,000 / meter until Council raises it	≈ \$1,209,000 ≈ \$1.21 million / year on CDP-only base	Proposed ordinance cap (annual)

Pay as a utility-bill credit if the county obtains a rider; otherwise a county rebate or property-tax credit labeled DAB Energy Dividend (Doubs · Adamstown · Buckeystown).

6. Zoning and DRRA hook

- § 1-19-10.1100 CDI overlay; LI/GI only; overlay less than 1% of county land.
- § 1-19-8.402 / 8.403 facilities and substations; 500-foot setback if abutting residential.
- Chapter 1-25 DRRA must list enhanced public benefits and their value — put the dividend and infrastructure lease in that paragraph.
- Maryland Supreme Court (opinion filed July 24, 2026): the overlay map is not a referendum subject. Change the map only by new plan and zoning acts.
- Aim conditions at new load, new map amendments, and any new DRRA. Do not claim confiscation of 2021 vested rights.

7. What this filing is not

Not a lawsuit. Not a protest. Not a political campaign. Neighbors with a plan — working people who fix what is broken, not politicians, activists, or consultants with a binder.

Not a request to raise taxes in Doubs, Adamstown, or Buckeystown. Not a ZIP-code subsidy. Not a substitute for a state data-center personal-property tax (support that separately and dedicate first dollars to this Trust). Not an invitation for Frederick City or other communities to freeloader onto Tier 1 without a board vote AND a new ordinance titled as an expansion. Not legal advice. Ask the County

Attorney which of A and C can be enacted under the Charter without a state bill, and publish the answer.

8. Prayer

Introduce the DAB ENERGY TRUST ordinance, attach Document 2 (bylaws) as the governing instrument, and refuse any DRRA that omits the dividend, gifts public infrastructure, or freezes zoning for a term of years. Keep the three communities exclusive by design. Keep the boundary the wall. Incorporate the Grandfather Clause and the Public Declaration — Host-Community Rebate as stated in this packet.

Respectfully submitted,

Nicholas Markoff

Buckeystown / DAB area, Frederick County, MD

I'm very busy with my newborn, but that doesn't mean I can't make a few minutes of my time available to quickly handle this. A mechanic's habit: when something is broken on our road home, you fix it — you don't wait for Winchester Hall to invent a feeling about it.

Sources (selected)

- Maryland Supreme Court opinion (July 24, 2026), In re Frederick County Data Center Referendum Committee, No. 67, Sept. Term 2025
- Frederick County CDI Overlay (Ord. 26-01-001)
- County Executive rejects Catellus community-benefits agreement (Sept. 14, 2026)
- Catellus \$110M community-benefit announcement (Sept. 1, 2026)
- HR&A Advisors, Quantum Frederick Data Center Development Impact Analysis (Oct. 30, 2025)
- County Executive Jessica Fitzwater, SB 427 testimony (Feb. 18, 2026)
- Sage Policy Group / Maryland Tech Council, Data Center Impact Report (Oct. 2023)
- Maryland State Data Center — Adamstown CDP 2020 Census profile (710 households)
- Frederick County — Buckeystown CDP 2020 Census Profile (499 households)
- Frederick County Data Centers page (application pause)
- Catellus hyperscale campus program (2.4 GW / 17.4M SF / ~2,100 acres)

D. Grandfather Clause — Keep This Version of Frederick

Purpose

We like it here. Keep Frederick looking like Frederick.

The Grandfather Clause is an **incentive to keep existing look, scale, and character** in Doubs, Adamstown, and Buckeystown. It rewards households and lawful uses that already exist — the communities as they stand — rather than subsidizing a growth wave that would change what these places are.

Cutoff date

January 20, 2026 — the effective date of Ordinance 26-01-001 (CDI overlay).

Who may qualify

Only **existing buildings, dwellings, and lawful uses as of the cutoff** may qualify for:

- Trust eligibility (Tier 1 meter / beneficiary status under the Trust rules),
- meter-credit / DAB Energy Dividend participation, and
- existing-community preference under Trust administration.

Eligibility still also requires a qualifying Tier 1 service address (Adamstown CDP, Buckeystown CDP, or published Doubs list) and the meter / homestead rules in the bylaws. The Grandfather Clause is an **additional** existing-community filter tied to the cutoff — not a substitute for geography.

What does not qualify

- **No new buildings qualify.**
- New construction, subdivisions, apartments, and commercial pads **after** the January 20, 2026 cutoff are **NOT grandfathered**.
- This clause is **not** a license to expand, intensify, or rebuild larger after the cutoff and still claim grandfathered Trust preference.
- It is an incentive to **keep what we have**, not a growth subsidy.

This is proposed ordinance / Trust policy language for Council to enact with the DAB ENERGY TRUST. It is not current law until adopted.

E. Public Declaration — Host-Community Rebate

Declaration

Host communities Doubs, Adamstown, and Buckeystown are why this revenue exists. The campus sits on our doorstep — on the rural-industrial and grid edge we live next to. The rest of the county collects the benefit of a burden we live next to.

Sourced figures show about **\$53 million** already collected on Quantum-related recordation transactions (\$1.40M + \$6.67M + \$44.9M = \$52.97M per HR&A). That money does not appear as a power-bill credit on DAB meters.

If countywide forecasts of about **\$41 million**, **\$68.8 million**, and **\$215 million** annual fiscal revenue at buildout are mentioned, they are labeled as **countywide buildout forecasts — not money in DAB pockets**. Those are Winchester Hall numbers, not Manor Woods numbers.

The Trust dividend is a **rebate due host communities** for site, grid edge, roads, rural buffer, and lived impact.

Nobody else generated this. Winchester Hall numbers came off Manor Woods ground.

How to hear this argument

This is a **rebate / credit** argument for host communities. It does **not** allege criminal theft or illegal conduct. Recordation and property-tax dollars follow county and state formula; the ask is that host communities receive an operator-funded meter credit and Trust structure because they carry the lived burden of the campus and overlay.

Neighbors with a plan. Not a lawsuit. Not a protest. Not a campaign committee.

F. Supporting materials

F.1 Bylaws highlights — DAB ENERGY TRUST

Article	Highlight
I — Name	DAB ENERGY TRUST (Doubs · Adamstown · Buckeystown). Seat in Doubs, Adamstown, or Buckeystown — not confined to Winchester Hall.
II — Purpose	Energy dividend to Tier 1 residential meters; funded by CDI load + infrastructure rent. ZIP codes are not the eligibility lock. Exclusive by design — not Frederick City.
III — Beneficiaries	Adamstown CDP + Buckeystown CDP + published Doubs list. Hard Census: 710 + 499 = 1,209 . Doubs ≠ CDP; no invented Doubs count. Expansion only by board vote + new expansion ordinance + elder consult where applicable.
IV — Board	Five voting members; ≥1 seat per town; default 2 / 2 / 1 . Until the Doubs list is adopted, the Doubs seat may be held interim by a Doubs-hamlet-area resident; once the list is live, that seat is Doubs-list only.
IV-A — Elections sketch	Weekend town hall; preferred Buckeystown UMC, 3440 Buckeystown Pike — permission pending . Proof: license, utility bill, or lease. Rough outline — not final election code.
V–VIII	Duties (MW reports, publish by March 31); restricted funds; quarterly meetings (Open Meetings); conflicts / recusal.
IX / IX-A	Amendment lock; elder consult — ten residents 65+ with ≥10 years in Doubs/Adamstown/Buckeystown before Tier 1 geography-change votes; advisory, not a veto.
X — Dissolution	Last dividend to Tier 1 meters; residue only to energy-burden aid within Tier 1.
Schedule A	Proposed floor \$250 / meter / year; \$1/MWh prior-12-month campus IT load between floor and cap; proposed cap \$1,000 ; not enacted until Council adopts.

Grandfather / rebate note for bylaws adoption: when Council enacts, fold cutoff **January 20, 2026** existing-building / lawful-use eligibility and host-community rebate framing into Schedule A / Article III as directed in Sections D and E of this packet.

F.2 One-page resident handout / script

DAB ENERGY TRUST

Doubs · Adamstown · Buckeystown — Our Home, Our Coalition

Read at the mic. Leave the handout on the table.

Spoken (aim ~90–120 seconds)

Why we're doing this — my wife pulls out of our driveway onto MD 85 with our six-month-old and has to time it like a gap in freeway traffic. That's not a statistic. That's our morning.

MD 85 is Buckeystown Pike — a state highway through the Buckeystown Historic District. We are Doubs, Adamstown, Buckeystown — Our Home, Our Coalition. We like it here. Keep Frederick looking like Frederick.

About twelve hundred census households in Adamstown and Buckeystown, plus Doubs on a published address list. The CDI overlay is mapped. Catellus is planned at two-point-four gigawatts. Construction is underway. About fifty-three million in Quantum-related recordation already collected — and it is not paying our electric bills.

No matter who you vote for, data centers are still going to be built here. A slogan does not stop steel. What we need is what we are due — a host-community rebate through a Trust we control: operator-funded meter credits. Nobody else generated this. Winchester Hall numbers came off Manor Woods ground.

Proposed floor two hundred fifty a year; proposed cap one thousand a year — dollar per megawatt-hour on prior-twelve-month campus IT load between those rails — not law until you pass it. Grandfather the buildings and lawful uses that existed on January twentieth, twenty twenty-six. No new buildings after that cutoff. Dividend is the floor; boundary is the wall — three communities only, not Frederick City.

Not a lawsuit. Not a protest. Not a political campaign. Neighbors with a plan.

Doubs, Adamstown, Buckeystown first. That is the ask.

Handout table

Who	Residential meters in Adamstown CDP, Buckeystown CDP, or on the published Doubs list (Doubs = hamlet, not a Census CDP). Not ZIP-locked. Grandfather: existing buildings/dwellings/lawful uses as of Jan. 20, 2026 only.
How many	Adamstown 710 + Buckeystown 499 = 1,209 Census households. No invented Doubs count.
Campus	Planned 2.4 GW · ~17.4M SF · ~2,100 acres (CDI overlay ≈ 2,614.9 acres) · construction underway
County collected	≈ \$53M Quantum-related recordation (HR&A \$52.97M). “\$110M” Catellus package rejected Sept. 14, 2026. Countywide forecasts \$41M / \$68.8M / \$215M = buildout forecasts, not DAB pocket money.
Proposed floor / cap	\$250 / \$1,000 per meter per year — \$1/MWh between floor and cap — proposed, NOT enacted law
Rebate frame	Host-community rebate for site, grid edge, roads, rural buffer, lived impact. Nobody else generated this. Winchester Hall numbers came off Manor Woods ground.
Three tools	A Trust · C public infrastructure lease · D residual / state equity bill
Boundary & board	Expansion only by board vote + new ordinance + elder consult. Board: five seats; each town ≥1; default 2/2/1.

Ask of candidates and officials:

I will put a DAB ENERGY TRUST dividend — megawatts to meters in Adamstown CDP, Buckeystown CDP, and on the Doubs list, with grandfather cutoff January 20, 2026 — ahead of any countywide data-center benefit or zoning freeze, and condition new CDI occupancy and any DRRA on that Trust.

F.3 Resident proposal letter

DAB ENERGY TRUST

Doubs · Adamstown · Buckeystown — Our Home, Our Coalition

A note to our neighbors in Doubs, Adamstown, and Buckeystown

Friends—

I'm a mechanic, not a speechwriter, so I'll keep this plain. Something big is landing on our edge of the county. No matter who you vote for, data centers are still going to be built here. The overlay is mapped. Construction is underway. A slogan does not stop steel.

So we carve out something for ourselves — because we absolutely should. It's our home. That carve-out is the **DAB ENERGY TRUST**: Doubs, Adamstown, and Buckeystown only — not Frederick City, not the whole county tagging along. Operators fund meter credits; we don't raise our tax rate. Proposed floor **\$250** and cap **\$1,000** per meter per year — the yearly credit follows prior-twelve-month campus IT load under the dollar-per-megawatt-hour rule, between those rails — proposed, not law yet.

We like it here. Keep Frederick looking like Frederick. Grandfather the buildings and lawful uses that already existed on **January 20, 2026**. No new construction after that cutoff gets Trust preference. And say it plain: host communities are why this revenue exists. About **\$53 million** already collected on Quantum-related recordation is not a local meter credit. Countywide forecasts are Winchester Hall numbers — not Manor Woods numbers. Nobody else generated this. Winchester Hall numbers came off Manor Woods ground. That is a rebate/credit argument — not an accusation of crime.

Hard Census numbers for the two census places: Adamstown **710** + Buckeystown **499** = **1,209** households. Doubs is a small unincorporated hamlet, not a census place — homes there join only on a published address list Council adopts by ordinance. We are not inventing a Doubs count.

Even outside data centers, apartments tend to follow. A Trust we control gives us a business deal we can live with and a line against that next wave of sprawl. Keep home beautiful.

Not a lawsuit. Not a protest. Not a political campaign. Neighbors with a plan. I'm very busy with my newborn; that doesn't mean I can't make a few minutes for this. If you're in Doubs, Adamstown, or Buckeystown, read this packet and help us get the ordinance introduced.

Our home. Our coalition.

Respectfully,

Nicholas Markoff

Buckeystown / DAB area, Frederick County, MD

P.S. Preferred town-hall sketch: Buckeystown United Methodist Church, 3440 Buckeystown Pike — permission pending. Bring a license, utility bill, or lease.